



NOW YOU SEE HIM NOW YOU DON'T: JOSEPH KASELLA BANTU MKASA WA PICHA YA WAASISI WA TANU 1954

Miongo minne iliyopita...

Hiyo makala "Now You See Him Now You Don't," yenye jina True Muslim huyo ni Mohamed Said. Makala haya yalichapwa kwenye jarida la New African (London) June 1985. Baada ya makala hii sikuficha tena jina langu. Hii makala Ally Sykes aliisoma na ilimgusa sana moyo wake. Sasa nilikuwa nimemueleza mwanae mmoja kuwa nimeandika makala hiyo na yeye akamueleza baba yake. Ally Sykes akamtuma mwanae aniite nikamuone. Hii ndiyo siku aliyonihidi kunionyesha Nyaraka za Sykes.

Katika makala hiyo kuna picha mbili za waasisi wa TANU.

Picha moja yumo Kasella Bantu na nyingine hayumo. Katika ile picha ambayo hayumo ile ndiyo picha yenyewe halisi na katika picha hiyo Ally Sykes, Tewa Said Tewa na Kasella Bantu

walika pembeni kuhofia wasifukuzwe kazi na serikali kwa kuasisi chama cha siasa. Kasella Bantu baada ya uhuru akapachika picha yake kati ya Abdulwahid Sykes na Dossa Aziz ili aonekane kuwa na yeye alikuwapo siku ile TANU inaasisiwa. Hapa ndipo lilipoanza tatizo la picha hii ya waasisi.

Katika kitabu cha maisha ya Julius Nyerere kuna maelezo ya picha hii lakini inasikitisha kwani yamekosewa. Tatizo limezidi kuongezeka. Huu ndiyo msukosuko wa historia ya TANU na kupigania uhuru wa Tanganyika.

READERS LETTERS

NOW YOU SEE HIM . . . NOW YOU DON'T

FORGED PICTURE



Above: Kasella Bantu provided this picture with himself depicted (top row, third from right) as evidence that he was a founder member of Tanu. Below: Other Tanu members provided the same picture but Kasella Bantu's face was missing. Who tampered with the original?

ORIGINAL PICTURE



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The popular theme among people like Kasella Bantu who jumped on the band-wagon in 1954 is that the struggle began on 7th July, 1954 the day Tanu was formed. The truth is that the struggle actually began in 1929, when a group of eight, six of them Muslims, met in Dar es Salaam to form Tanganyika African Association. These pioneers of the struggle for independence were: Mzee Bin Sudi, Ibrahim Hamisi, Raikes Kusi, Rawson Watts, Kleist Sykes, Ali Saidi Mpima, Zibe Kidasi, Suleman Majisu.

Anyone conversant with the history of Tanganyika will understand why it had to be the Muslims in the forefront challenging the British Colonial administration. The Christians were a privileged class and were supposed to be loyal towards the colonial government. The Muslims were an underprivileged group and they showed

their resentment of the colonial policy by forging unity among themselves while keeping the door open for their Christian brothers. Abdul Waheed Sykes and Daw Azis then invited their friend Julius Nyerere to join the TAA. They, together with many prominent Muslims, went out of their way to make him accepted in this largely Muslim country.

It was a harder task to take people like Kasella Bantu into the fold because of the superiority complex obtained through his colonial education. The British had done a thorough job on them, giving them education and providing a special housing scheme for the Christian élites. All that was a ploy by the British to create disparity among the people. Mr Kasella Bantu, being one of these privileged, knows this is the truth.

True Muslim

Dar es Salaam, Tanzania

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